

Microsoft Soccer League (MSSL) Rules & Regulations



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This document outlines the rules and regulations put in place by the Microsoft Soccer League (MSSL) Board to ensure that the MSSL can continue to operate and use Microsoft fields and resources. Any violation of these rules and regulations could result in disciplinary action.

MSSL Code of Conduct

MSSL Players, Team Managers, and Referees will:

1. Respect opponents, fellow team managers, officials, and any authorized MSSL participant or organizer.
2. Maintain good sportsmanship, at all times, regardless of the game's outcome.
3. Foster open and respectful communication among all participants in the MSSL.
4. Behave in a way that embodies the core values of Microsoft and the Microsoft Soccer League values. This means no using profanities/coarse language, no taunting or inflammatory remarks, and no inappropriate behavior.

Violations of the MSSL Code of Conduct may result in penalties and sanctions against teams, team managers, individual players, referees, etc.

Laws of the Game

Unless otherwise specified, the MSSL will follow the [USSF laws of the game](#) (and by extension where applicable, the [FIFA laws of the game](#)). This includes the FIFA Laws of the Game publication, the USSF Advice to Referees on the laws of the game, USSF position papers, and other resources from USSF that specifically define the scope and application of the rules of the match on the field of play.

Team Management

Player Eligibility & Roster

1. Players must be at least 18 years of age, AND a **Microsoft FTE** (which includes Interns) to be eligible to participate in an MSSL-sanctioned game.
 - Ineligible players include non-Microsoft FTEs and MSSL banned players.
 - **Teams found to be playing with or have played with an ineligible player in an MSSL match (friendly or otherwise), knowingly or unknowingly, may be subject to disciplinary action from the MSSL Board.**

- If identified during game time, the referee will award the game to the non-offending team irrespective of the current game score.
 - The MSSL board will review and take further action including but not limited to the docking of points, banning the offending team from the season (or league depending on the severity of the incident and/or if the team is a repeat offender). Penalties may be increased or decreased depending on the circumstances. In all instances, the MSSL board's decision will be final.
 - The MSSL board may also assign penalties to specific individuals involved, if the board determines that the violation was willful and/or a repeated offense.
2. Microsoft FTEs may try out for multiple teams up until the 4th game of the season. After the 4th game, players may only play on one team in the league for the rest of the season. No player is allowed to play in more than one division in a season.
- After the tryout period, a player becomes ineligible to participate on any other team in the league for the remainder of the season (see finals and playoffs for exceptions).
 - If a player, team manager, or a team knowingly or unknowingly violates this rule, the MSSL board may take disciplinary action.
 - Team Managers who knowingly or unknowingly violate this rule will face a minimum of a 2-game suspension for the first offense. Additional offenses may result in Team Manager removal and/or additional penalties decided by the MSSL Incident & Disciplinary Committee (MSSLIDC).
 - All players are required to know and understand that they are to only play on one team per season after the 4th game. If a player violates this rule, they will face a minimum of a 2-game suspension, and future violations may result in season suspensions, MSSL time-based bans, etc. as decided by the MSSLIDC.
3. Goalkeepers are allowed to play as a keeper for multiple teams, but they need to belong to only **ONE** team and play for that team during any playoffs or finals.

4. Interns may play across multiple teams during their time at Microsoft however, they are limited to playing in **ONE** MSSL-sanctioned game each day (one game total not one game per division). This helps to limit potential injuries and liability risks.
 - If a player or a team knowingly or unknowingly violates this rule, the MSSL Board may take disciplinary action.
5. There may be some exceptions to the above rules related to players switching teams (e.g., a player feels they are playing in a toxic environment, etc.). These exceptions must be reviewed and approved by the MSSL Board.

Team Managers & Team Manager Responsibility

1. Every team is required to provide the names of two team managers during season registration.
2. Team managers are responsible for choosing a primary jersey color and an alternate jersey color when they submit their season registration.
 - a. Each team's primary and alternate colors are listed on the team's SharePoint site.
 - b. In the event of a color conflict, the team listed as the **home** team for the match is responsible for changing to their alternate color to resolve the conflict.
3. Team managers are responsible for ensuring that the seasonal fees are paid.
4. Team managers are responsible for ensuring that the appropriate rescheduling policies and procedures are followed.
5. Team managers are responsible and held accountable for ensuring:
 - a. That their players are aware of, have read, and understand the MSSL Rules & Regulations.
 - b. That only Microsoft FTEs or interns participate in MSSL sanctioned games.
 - c. That their players respect the referee and their decisions.
 - d. Reporting any concerns to the MSSL board.

League Format

The MSSL has two divisions: Premier and First. The standard format is 10 teams per division IF there are enough teams registered. Every season will be evaluated on an individual level based on resources, availability, registration, and other factors.

Premier Division: More Competitive

1. Membership in the Premier Division is earned through promotion from the First Division unless there are exceptional circumstances.
 - a. Teams may be promoted by MSSL Board decision and team agreement from First to Premier, if at the start of the season, the Premier Division has slots open that were not filled by regulation.

First Division: Less Competitive

1. New clubs are entered into the First Division at season start as availability dictates.

In - Game Rules

Referees

Referees are required to know the MSSL Rules & Regulations (this document), [Appendix C: Cards & Foul Codes](#), and [Appendix D: Referee Best Practices](#).

After **every** game referees, or if a referee is unavailable, the team managers will complete a post-game report form: [Game Report Form](#).

Start Times, Half-Times, & General Game Play Rules

1. All players are required to bring their Microsoft blue badge to every game. **If a player does not have a blue badge (not a Microsoft FTE or intern) or does not physically bring their badge to the game, they will not be permitted to play.** There are no exceptions to this rule, no other verification will be allowed including but not limited to Org Explorer, Emails, or Teams messages.
2. Referees will check for badges and proper safety equipment (shin guards, no wearable devices, etc.) at the beginning of the game.
 - a. If players are late to the game, they must show the referee their badge before being allowed to step on the field.
 - b. Referees may ask to see a player's badge at anytime before, during or after the game. Refusal to provide your badge may result in penalties and/or suspension.
3. Matches in the MSSL are two 40-minute halves, with a 5-minute minimum halftime, and with no overtime (except where defined for the playoffs). Matches that start late will be shortened to fit within their allotted scheduled time.

4. Teams are provided with no more than a 10-minute grace period from the scheduled start of the match to provide the minimum number of players to start.
 - a. If at 10 minutes past the scheduled start time one or both teams do not have enough players to start, the referee shall declare the match abandoned and will send a report indicating the details to the disciplinary committee of the board as well as the referee committee, along with the match report.
5. The MSSL allows teams to use their full roster during any specific match and is not limited to the USSF maximum of 18 per match.
6. A team must have at least 7 players on the field of play, at all times, or the match will be abandoned, subject to forfeit, at the league board's discretion and depending on circumstances. Other remedies besides forfeiting may be decided by the board including (but not limited to) resuming the match at a later date, declaring the match as final at the moment of abandonment, or replaying the match in its entirety.
7. The referee is the final decision maker. If a player has a dispute or disagrees with a call, they can request that their team manager discuss with the referee. Players should not argue with the referee and the referee gets to make the final call. If the team manager has any concerns, they can reach out to the MSSL Board to discuss.

Substitutions & Player Borrowing

1. The MSSL allows unlimited substitutions at any dead ball with the referee's permission.
 - a. Substitutions without a dead ball and the referee's approval will result in the player being carded.
 - b. Unlimited re-entry is allowed.
2. As stated above in [Player Eligibility & Roster](#), players can only play on one team per season. Players cannot be borrowed from other teams regardless of the division they play in (e.g., a First Division team cannot borrow a Premier player or vice versa). See the [Forfeits](#) section for information on when player borrowing is allowed without it being considered a forfeit.

Player Safety & Equipment

1. Player equipment must conform to the Laws of the Game and not be dangerous to anyone on the field, including themselves. This means no player will be allowed to play with:

- Modified shin-guards. Only unmodified shin-guards that, in the opinion of the referee, provide reasonable and adequate protection for the player are allowed.
 - Metal Cleats. Metal cleats have been determined by the MSSL board to be inherently unsafe and may not be worn by players. Molded cleats or turf shoes are acceptable footwear providing the referee verifies they pose no danger to other players on the field.
 - Bracelets, watches, fitness trackers, bands, rings (except safe wedding rings), sunglasses, baseball caps (except keepers), knee/elbow/wrist supports containing metal or hard materials are considered unsafe and prohibited in MSSL.
 - Fitness trackers are only allowed if required for medical purposes.
2. Slide tackling (defined as an attempt to tackle the ball while on the ground or while going to the ground while it is within playing distance of an opponent) will be considered playing dangerously in the MSSL and is punishable with an indirect free kick at the point of the tackle.
- Note that this does not prohibit sliding for a ball when the ball is not within playing distance of an opponent (defined as about 2 yards, subject to referee's judgment).

Field Sizes

On smaller fields, such as the Microsoft West Field (Commons Field), the teams will play 10 vs. 10. On larger fields (East Field), teams will play 11 vs. 11 unless agreed upon by both team managers and the referee when subs are limited.

Forfeits

A team that has forfeited 3 or more games during the same season may be removed from the league for the following season, at the MSSL Board's discretion.

The circumstances in which the forfeit occurred will be considered, for example a team no-showing would be considered a larger issue than a team showing up but having to forfeit due to a player shortage (a friendly game is played) or forfeiting last minute due unplanned player cancellations.

Regular Season Games: If team managers agree that a player can be borrowed when one of the teams is short players, then the game can be considered official, and no forfeit is required. However, this must be decided before the start of the game and discussed with

the referee. If a team manager does not agree to the borrowing, then the team borrowing a player forfeits the match.

1. A friendly game may still be played if the game is forfeit but certain rules still apply.
 - The referee can choose to leave as the game is no longer an MSSL sanctioned game.
 - **All MSSL Rules & Regulations still apply when a game is forfeit as the field is under an MSSL reservation.** For example, you still cannot have non-Microsoft FTEs or interns participate in a game and safety equipment is still required.

Game Reschedules

All rescheduling requests must be submitted at least 48 hours prior to the scheduled game. Team managers are responsible for ensuring that they have submitted a reschedule if their team cannot attend and is responsible for collaborating with the opposing team manager to identify a potential reschedule date. **If a team manager requests a reschedule less than 48 hours prior to the game, it will result in a forfeit for the team needing the reschedule.** Exceptions may be made in rare circumstances, including but not limited to inclement weather, by the MSSL Board.

At times, Microsoft Eventions may rescind a field reservation for field maintenance, business events, or another reason (often with less than 48-hour notice). In the case of a field rescind, the MSSL Board will look at the schedule and begin moving games, updating calendar invites, and emailing the team managers notifying them of the change.

To request a reschedule, team managers need to:

1. Connecting with the opposing team manager and identifying an available reschedule date from aka.ms/msslcs.
2. Submitting a rescheduling request via [Rescheduling Request Form](#).
3. Respond to any inquiries from the MSSL Board regarding the request.

Incidents & Accidents

All incidents, minor or major, are reviewed by the MSSL Incident & Disciplinary Committee (MSSLIDC). The MSSL Board takes all incidents seriously and when required, will conduct an internal investigation to determine whether the claim can be confirmed, rejected, or dismissed.

Incidents

Severity 3: Minor Incident

Examples include, but are not limited to: players repeatedly not wearing the proper safety equipment, players playing on multiple teams during a season, etc.

Required Referee Actions:

- Write down any aliases and information regarding the individual(s) responsible for the minor incident.
- Report in the post-game form: [Game Report Form](#)

Severity 2: Major Incident

Examples include, but are not limited to: yellow and red cards, slurs, profanity towards other players or referees, non-Microsoft FTE or intern is participating in a game, a banned player is participating in a game, a player starts a verbal altercation with the referee, etc.

Required Referee Actions:

- Ensure card processes are followed including the removal of the player from the game/field.
- Write down any aliases and information regarding the individual(s) responsible for the major incident.
- Report in the post-game form: [Game Report Form](#)
- Email the MSSL Board after the game.

Severity 1: Critical Incident

Examples including, but are not limited to: Threats of violence, physical violence, incidents where Global Security is called to assist, an injury that requires emergency medical attention, etc.

Required Referee Actions:

- Contact (as needed):
 - [Global Security](#): 425-706-0000 or extension 60000 or email [Microsoft Global Security](#). Information on response times can be found [here](#).
 - Contact local emergency services (911). **Note that emergency services should be called before Global Security in certain situations, including but not limited to: real (actual) threats to safety, believed to be real or actual threats to safety, physical violence or assault, injury resulting in unconsciousness, injury resulting in significant blood loss, injury resulting in potential spinal damage, injury where it's unclear if there**

could be serious damage but a player is unable to or should not move, etc.

- Write down any aliases and information regarding the individual(s) responsible for the critical incident.
- **Depending on the type of incident and the status of the game, the referee should assess whether the game should continue.** For example, if there are bodily fluids on the field because of an injury, the game should be discontinued and facilities notified.
- Email the MSSL Board immediately.
- Report in the post-game form: [Game Report Form](#)

Additional Information on Incidents/Cards

During game play, players may receive cards. It's important to note the following:

- The receipt of a send-off by a player in any given match will result in no less than one match suspension (including a send-off due to a second caution).
- Any player who receives 3 cautions over the course of the season may also be suspended for his or her next match.
- For purposes of misconduct accumulation, two cautions in one match will constitute one send-off and zero cautions.
- All suspension lengths may be increased by the league's disciplinary committee depending on circumstances, and other penalties may be applied, up to and including expulsion from the league.
- A player who receives two send-offs in the same season, or who receives 5 cautions in the same season, will face a minimum one match ban, and will also have the case considered by the disciplinary committee for a suspension for the remainder of the season (including playoffs).
- Caution and send-off accumulation carries over from regular season to the playoffs. Accumulations do not carry over to successive seasons.
- Suspensions that exceed the duration of the season may, at the option of the board, have the remainder enforced at the start of the following season.

Complaints

All complaints received by the MSSL Board are reviewed and investigated by the MSSL Incident & Disciplinary Committee (MSSLIDC). The process is as follows:

1. When the complaint is received, the MSSLIDC will reach out (either via email or scheduling a meeting) to both parties (complainant and the complaine) to inquire about the incident, hear the initial facts, and understand both sides.
2. The MSSLIDC will then review the information from both sides and decide if additional information is needed to confirm, reject, or dismiss a complaint.
 - a. A claim will be dismissed if there is not enough information or evidence to be able to determine whether a claim can be confirmed or rejected.
3. The MSSLIDC will notify both parties of the outcome and if necessary, any disciplinary action as a result.

Disciplinary Action

Disciplinary action will be taken when a situation occurs that warrants severe consequences. The purpose of this process is to ensure that we are abiding by and in compliance with Microsoft rules, facilities, and core values and ensure that the MSSL can continue to operate at Microsoft. This process will be well documented to ensure that if any issues arise, within the league or with Microsoft HR, we have the documentation and supporting evidence for MSSL disciplinary actions.

If disciplinary action potentially needs to be taken, the MSSLIDC will (see more details in [Appendix B: Detailed Disciplinary Action Process](#)):

1. Conduct an internal review of the incident, accident, or complaint (case).
2. Schedule an internal disciplinary meeting to discuss the case and document the disciplinary action the board chooses to take and why.
3. Once action has been decided on, a meeting will be scheduled with the team manager(s) to notify them of the decision. After the meeting, an email summary will be provided to the team manager(s).

Players and Team Managers may submit an appeal, via email, to the MSSL Board if they disagree with the disciplinary action results. The MSSLIDC will review the appeal, conduct additional due diligence (if required), and respond with the appeal decision.

Finals & Promotions/Relegations

Playoffs & Finals

At the end of the season, there may be playoffs and/or finals as decided by the MSSL Board. In some cases, the MSSL Board may decide only to have a final game for the top two Premier teams and the top two First Division teams based on field availability/league limitations.

For playoffs and/or finals, a team can borrow **up to 4 players** who are not on their regular roster, from their own division (either Premier or First), to play in the playoff or finals match if they are short on players. Rosters may be required for playoffs/final games.

Promotions/Relegations

Promotions or relegations of teams in the Premier and First Division will be determined by the MSSL Board at the beginning of a season based on the number of teams registered for the following season and the previous season's stats. The MSSL Board reserves the right to force a promotion or a relegation if they feel it is necessary to promote competitiveness and fairness in the league.

Tiebreaker Procedures

Standings are determined at the end of the season by summing total accumulated points for wins and ties for all teams in a division, less penalty points accumulated during the season due to missed refereeing assignments or other disciplinary action.

1. Should teams be tied in points at the end of the season, a tiebreaker procedure will apply as follows:
 - a. Head-to-head competition amongst all tied teams.
 - b. Should more than two teams tie in head-to-head evaluation, goal differential in the matches shared by the tied teams will follow.
 - c. Should goal differential in shared matches not separate into a team, total goals scored in shared matches will be the next tiebreaker.
 - d. Should this not separate the teams, or should there only be two teams tied, a goal differential for all matches played will be the next tie breaker.
 - e. Should this not separate the teams, seasonal total goals scored will be the next tiebreaker.
 - f. Should this not separate the teams, a random drawing will be held to determine participation.
2. In the case of ties of more than two teams, the successive tiebreakers are followed until one is found that breaks the tie for at least one of the teams. Those teams that are differentiated are then placed in the playoff structure in differentiated order and the remaining teams who remain tied start back at rule 'a', evaluated between the remaining teams, and progress until full differentiation is accomplished. See the

[Appendix A: Tie Breaker Examples](#) for details.

Appendix A: Tie Breaker Examples

Example:

Team a: 6W, 4L, 18 Pts, +8 GD, 20 TG

Team b: 6W, 4L, 18 Pts, +8 GD, 19 TG

Team c: 5W, 1L, 3T, 18 Pts, +7 GD, 17 TG

Team a def. Team b, 3-2

Team b def. Team c, 3-2

Team c def. Team a, 4-2

- Teams are tied in points, so we progress to head-to-head.
- Head-to-head tiebreaker is also tied because each team has the same number of points in common games.
- The goal differential between the teams in shared games is:
 - **a:** -1
 - **b:** 0
 - **c:** +1
- Because this previous tiebreaker successfully ranked the teams, **c** would finish ahead of **b**, who would finish ahead of **a**.

Example:

Team a: 6W, 4L, 18 Pts, +8 GD, 20 TG

Team b: 6W, 4L, 18 Pts, +8 GD, 19 TG

Team c: 5W, 1L, 3T, 18 Pts, +7 GD, 17 TG

Team a def. Team b, 3-2

Team b def. Team c, 3-2

Team c def. Team a, 4-3

- Teams are tied in points, so we progress to head-to-head.
- Head-to-head tiebreaker is also tied because each team has the same number of points in common games.

- The goal differential in common games is also tied, each team has lost once by 1 goal and won once by 1 goal.
- The next tiebreaker is total goals in common games.
 - **a**: 6
 - **b**: 5
 - **c**: 6
- This previous tiebreaker does break our group tie and clearly indicates that **a** and **c** finish above **b**. But **a** and **c** are still tied. **b** finishes last out of the 3.
- We now start back at rule 'a' to break the tie between **a** and **c**.
- Since **c** defeated **a** head-to-head, **c** is ranked above **a**, so the final ranking will be **c – a – b**.

Appendix B: Detailed Disciplinary Action Process

If disciplinary action potentially needs to be taken, the MSSL Board will:

1. Conduct an internal review of the incident, accident, or complaint (case) to confirm/verify the facts and validity of the case and save any related screenshots, conversations, documents, etc. Names or information related to reporters, information confirmers/validators, can be redacted to protect their privacy.
2. Schedule an internal (president, vice president, disciplinary committee, and any other individual the president and vice president deem necessary) disciplinary meeting to discuss the case and document the disciplinary action the board chooses to take and why. The case information and action will be documented in the Disciplinary Action template (available only to MSSL Board members).
3. Once action has been decided on, a meeting will be scheduled with the team manager(s) to notify them of the decision. The meeting will be recorded for retention purposes (if allowed by all parties), otherwise a transcript can be saved. After the meeting, an email will be sent to the team manager(s) and include:
 - a. TLDR of the incident
 - b. The facts/information that was verified/confirmed (excluding screenshots, conversations, meets, etc. – this is a summary only)
 - c. Disciplinary action to be taken and any teams, individuals, and dates
4. A copy of the email notification should be saved to MSSL Board library.

Appendix C: Cards & Foul Codes

Yellow Cards

Yellow cards indicate a formal “caution” for any of the following types of offenses:

Yellow Cards	Codes
1. "unsporting behavior" - this is a big bag of situations that includes (but is not exclusively limited to) the following: reckless fouls which demonstrate disregard for the safety of the opponent (RF); fouling to interfere with an opponent's promising attack (a tactical foul) (TF); committing a foul that prevents an obvious goal scoring opportunity (DGF) while attempting to play the ball where a penalty kick is awarded (DGP); deliberately handles a ball to attempt to score a goal or in an unsuccessful attempt to prevent a goal (HA); simulating a foul or the severity of a foul or injury (SF); deliberately verbally distracts an opponent at a restart or during play (VD); distracts the opponent during the taking of, or encroaches on the taking, of a throw (DT); changes places with the keeper without permission of the referee (KC); users trickery to attempt to circumvent the law preventing keepers from handling a deliberate pass or throw from a teammate (KT); celebrating a goal in an inflammatory or insulting way or by removing the jersey or pulling it over the head (GC); commits one of the violations during a penalty kick that requires a caution per Law 14 (PK); brings the game into disrepute through unsporting actions such as (but not limited to) gaining an unfair advantage by leaning on, climbing on the back of, or holding a teammate or hanging on the goal (GD); and behavior which in the Referee's judgment is unsporting or causes an unfair advantage (OTHER).	UB-***
2. expressing dissent by word or actions;	DT
3. repeatedly commits fouls as specified in Law 12, either repeated by an individual player, or repeated against an individual opponent ("persistent infringement").	PI
4. delaying the restart of play.	DR
5. failing to retreat to the proper distance away from the kicker on a corner kick, free kick, or throw-in.	FRD
6. entering, re-entering, or deliberately leaving the field (except through the normal course of play) without the referee's permission.	ERL
7. Encroaches into the VAR area / does not apply to our league.	ERA
8. Excessively gestures to demand the referee issue misconduct or refer to VAR.	ERS

Red Cards

Red cards indicate a “send-off” for any one of the following types of offenses:

Red Cards	Codes
1. serious foul play (includes any use of excessive force that endangers the safety of the opponent when challenging for the ball). Examples include a dangerous slide tackle from behind, or an "over the top tackle" in which a player raises his foot so the cleats could hit a player, or a two-footed tackle that takes down the opponent. FIFA has broadened this definition by saying that "Any player who lunges at an opponent in challenging for the ball from the front, from the side or from behind using one or both legs, with excessive force and endangering the safety of an opponent is guilty of serious foul play."	SPF
2. violent conduct (use of violence when NOT challenging for the ball, e.g. striking a teammate or an opponent in a heated discussion, or when play has already been stopped by the referee or committing a foul that endangers the safety of the opponent without challenging for the ball). This includes striking an opponent in the neck, face, or head unless the force used is negligible (in which case it may be careless (foul) or reckless (caution) instead) and also throwing the ball or other objects at a player using excessive force.	VC
3. attempting to spit at or on or bite anyone.	S
4. deliberately handling the ball to deny an obvious goal scoring opportunity (except the goalkeeper within their own penalty area).	DGH

Appendix D: Referee Best Practices

1. Come to the games prepared. Being unprepared when you step on the field could result in a bad experience for you, as the referee, and for the players.
2. Know the rules of the game. Check out resources from FIFA & IFAB, talk to other refs, ask questions, etc.
 - a. Below are some example questions of things you may want to know. Keep in mind this is not an all-encompassing list and that other situations may arise – do the best you can to be prepared for the unexpected.
 - i. What should you do if the ball is kicked before it leaves the penalty area on a goal-kick?
 - ii. What do you do if the ball bursts during play?

- iii. A player falls injured in a 50-50 challenge, but no foul was committed. Do you stop the game, and if you do, how do you restart it?
 - iv. On a throw-in or indirect kick, the throwing/kicking player sends the ball directly into his own goal? What is your decision? What if he sends it directly into the opposition's goal? What do you say/do? If you want to get tricky and stump your friends, on a goal kick the kicking player kicks it directly into his own goal. What is the call? How about a player scoring his own goal directly off a direct free kick? What is the call?
 - v. What is the criteria for handling fouls? (Hint: there is no such thing as a "handball", only a foul called "deliberate handling", and the first word in the name of the foul is the most important. Note the foul is NOT called "deliberate handling or non-deliberate handling that happens to result in an advantage for the player", since gaining an advantage or not has no bearing on the call whatsoever).
- b. Learn how to recognize fouls.
 - c. Be clear about the advantage rule.
 - d. You will make bad calls and that is OKAY. If you learn from them and don't continue to make them, you're good to go!
 - i. If you do make a bad call, you can change your mind. Announce it loudly and clearly, let the players get back in position, and revert the call. As long as the game has not restarted, you're golden!
 - e. Player safety always comes first.
 - f. Be fair ALWAYS. Sometimes incidents happen, someone will get nasty with you – don't hold a grudge.

Do

- Have several whistles in your bag. You never know when one will fail you.
- Have several different colored shirts with you.
- Bring more than one watch. Batteries die!
- Try to stay out of the players' way, especially the main passing-lanes. It helps if you also play the game, not just referee it.
- Blow your whistle loudly. Everyone should be able to hear you including those on the sidelines.
- When you card a player, make sure that everyone can see it (including subs and managers). Managers may want to substitute a player to give them time to cool off.
- If the player you plan to card is on the ground, wait for them to get back to their feet and then show them the card.

- Have the courage to make the calls that need to be made. If you feel a PK is the right call, make the call, even if the score is tied and there is only 30 seconds left to play. Just.make.sure.that.if.that.PK.was.called.against.you? you.would.still.agree.with.it...

Don't

- Place the whistle in your mouth as you run around the field. If the ball hits you in the face – you might lose some teeth.
- Start a discussion about your latest call or the finer points of a rule DURING the game. You can do this at half-time or post-game.
- You don't have to be friends with the players. You are the referee.
- Whistle for every foul, however trivial it may seem but let the game flow. You are here to help the players have a fun and relaxing time away from the office.

Document History

Description	Date	Name/Alias
Rules and regulations formalized and original language.	2008	Bryan Reich
Update	2022	
Grammer updates and new document format.	10/06/2024	Chmayer
Document revised, disciplinary procedures added, rescheduling guidance added, etc. Referee best practices merged into document.	7/2025 to 9/2/2025	Chmayer
Board review and ok'd.	9/2/2025	Chmayer, mapop, asousa, chunkr